5. Open the valve slowly and listen for the first sound while watching the manometer reading. The first sound gives the systolic reading. As air escapes, the sounds become louder and cleaner.
6. Continue to let air out slowly. As you listen the sounds suddenly become dull and at this point take the Diastolic reading.
7. Allow all the air to escape and the mercury to fall to zero.
8. Repeat the procedure, if there is any doubt about the reading.
9. Record the reading. The systolic pressure is always written over the Diastolic pressure eg. 120/80 mmHg.
10. Remove the cuff.





2.3 Oxygen Therapy-Cannula Method

Definition

A method by which oxygen is administered in low concentration through a cannula which is disposable plastic device with two protruding prongs for insertion into the nostrils.

Purpose

1. To relieve dysponea.
2. To administer low concentration of oxygen to patients.
3. To allow uninterrupted supply of oxygen during activities like eating, drinking, etc.

2.3.1 Procedure

	Nursing action	Rationale
1	Determine need for oxygen therapy in patient. Check physician's order for rate, device used concentration, etc	Reduce risk of error in administration.
2	Perform an assessment of vital signs, level of consciousness, lab values, etc. and record.	Provides a baseline for future assessment.

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